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The Revolving Door: How the NNP Gave Away Grenada's Biggest Seat

St. George South holds the airport, Grand Anse, the university and most of the hotels. The NNP has sent it four candidates in four elections, lost it by 2,792 votes, and failed to win a single polling division. Here is how it could start again.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. GEORGE SOUTH, GRENADA

ST. GEORGE SOUTH, GRENADA—No constituency in Grenada matters more to the economy than St. George South, and none has been handled more carelessly by the New National Party. It is the country's largest seat, with 12,103 registered voters this year, nearly three times the Town of St. George. It takes in Grand Anse, True Blue, L'Anse aux Épines, Calliste, Woburn and Springs, along with the international airport at Point Salines, St. George's University and most of the island's major hotels. On 5 November the NDC's Andy Williams took 4,637 votes to 1,845 for the NNP's Christopher DeAllie Jr. The NNP has treated this seat as a posting. Mr. Williams has treated it as home.

> **"A full slate is a press release. An office, a staff, a canvass list and a budget are a campaign."**
> GREG HOSTEN

FOUR ELECTIONS, FOUR CANDIDATES

Look at who the NNP has put on the ballot here. In 2013 it was Alexandra Otway-Noel. In 2018 it was Nickolas Steele. In 2022 it was Norland Cox. In 2026 it was Christopher DeAllie Jr. That is four different candidates in four consecutive elections, in the one seat where name recognition is hardest to build because the electorate is so large.

Each change reset the clock. Voters in Grand Anse and Calliste never got to know one NNP representative over several terms, and the party never gave a candidate the time to become part of the furniture. In politics, the absence of a familiar face is itself a message, and the message here was that the seat could be filled from anywhere.

NINE YEARS IN POWER BOUGHT NO LOYALTY

The NNP held St. George South for the whole of its nine years in government, from 2013 to 2022. It had ministers, budgets and the airport, the beach and the hotel belt under its administration. It lost the seat at the first election after it lost power, and in 2026 it lost it by more than two and a half times the 2022 margin.

That is the sharpest indictment in this volume. The NNP's hold on the south was a hold of incumbency, not of organisation. Mr. Steele's 3,536 votes in 2018 were the party's high point, and the party appears to have mistaken a sitting minister's personal vote for a party base. When the minister retired and the government changed, there was nothing underneath. Since 2018 the NNP's vote here has fallen from 3,536 to 1,845. It has lost almost half its voters in eight years.

2022: THE MINISTER FROM CARRIACOU

The clearest example came in 2022. With Mr. Steele retiring, the NNP branch endorsed Norland Cox at the end of January as its candidate. Mr. Cox was the Infrastructure Development Minister and a senator, and he was from Carriacou. The party was, in effect, running a sister-isle minister against a Grand Anse businessman in Grand Anse.

The NDC's choice was Andy Williams, founder of the Hot Spot supermarket chain and a former financial comptroller at the Rex Grenadian hotel. He was local, known and visible. On polling day he took 4,029 votes to Mr. Cox's 2,961, a margin of 1,068.

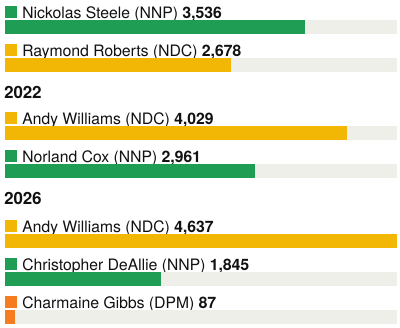
Mr. Cox did not stay to fight again. In September 2025 the NNP named him caretaker for Carriacou and Petite Martinique, where he lost again this year, 2,392 votes to 1,416. The party moved its 2022 candidate to a different seat and lost both.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE COLLAPSE

This is not one bad night. It is two in a row.

2018 VS 2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



2,792 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

12,103
Registered voters, the most of any seat

0 of 33
Polling divisions won by the NNP

54.5%
Turnout, the lowest of all 15 seats

–1,691
Fall in the NNP vote since 2018

Between 2018 and 2022 the NNP's share of the two-party vote here fell from 56.9 per cent to 42.4 per cent, a drop of 14.5 points. Between 2022 and 2026 it fell again, to 28.5 per cent, a further 13.9 points, against a national fall of 10.3 points. The south turned on the NNP more sharply than the country did.

The make-up of the change matters. In 2022 the NDC gained 1,351 votes while the NNP lost only 575, so more than half of Mr. Williams's new votes came from people who had not backed either party in 2018. In 2026 the pattern reversed. The NNP lost 1,116 votes and the NDC gained only 608. Even if every one of the NDC's new votes came from NNP switchers, at least 508 of the NNP's 2022 voters simply did not vote for anyone. The NNP is no longer only losing the argument here. It is losing its own people to the sofa.

Measured against the whole electorate, the picture is starker. Mr. Williams won the votes of 38 per cent of every registered voter in the constituency. Mr. DeAllie won 15 per cent. There was no split to blame: the DPM and the Grenada Social Democratic Party took 95 votes between them.

One seat also carries outsized national weight. This year St. George South alone supplied 12.4 per cent of every vote the NDC won nationally. A party that writes this seat off is ignoring one in every eight votes its opponent won.

NOT ONE POLLING DIVISION

The polling-division results are the most brutal evidence of all. The NNP did not carry a single one of the seat's 33 divisions. Its best result anywhere was 37.8 per cent of the two-party vote, at Blessed Sacrament R.C. School. Its worst was 20.6 per cent, at the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints polling station. In the two Woburn Community Centre divisions it took barely one vote in four.

There is no NNP stronghold in the south to build from. There is no village where the party can say its message is working. Every rebuilding plan has to start from the same place: a constituency where, at best, three voters in eight chose the NNP.

A CARETAKER WITHOUT A BASE

The NNP named Christopher DeAllie Jr. caretaker on 23 April 2025, about 19 months before the vote. He is a business and finance professional with a degree in business management and a postgraduate diploma in financial planning, and he founded what the party described as the island's first indoor mushroom farm. On paper, that is a credible profile for a seat full of entrepreneurs and professionals.

But 19 months is not long in a constituency of 12,000 voters, and the support around him was thin. In 2025 The New Today reported speculation that several new NNP caretakers, Mr. DeAllie among them, were working without party offices. In the same report a former NNP minister accused Dr. Keith Mitchell of not doing enough to help the new caretakers financially, and said only the sitting NNP MPs had constituency offices, funded by the state. Against a sitting minister with a permanent office in Grand Anse, the NNP sent a newcomer without one.

In February 2026 the NNP announced that it was the first party to name a full slate of 15 candidates. A full slate is a press release. An office, a staff, a canvass list and a budget are a campaign, and in the south the NNP had the first without the second.

ANDY WILLIAMS MADE HIMSELF THE SEAT

Mr. Williams, meanwhile, turned one term into a fixture. He became Minister for Mobilisation, Implementation and Transformation, the NDC's General Secretary, and one of the ministers most often appointed Acting Prime Minister when Dickon Mitchell travelled, including in May 2024, over Christmas 2024 and in May 2026. Each appointment put the MP for St. George South at the top of the government in the eyes of his own voters.

His 4,637 votes were 608 more than in 2022, in a year when fewer people voted. He won every polling division, from Springs to Calliste. That is what a constituency machine looks like.

THE 5,510 WHO STAYED HOME

The most damning number in St. George South is not a candidate's total. Turnout here this year was 54.5 per cent, the lowest of all 15 constituencies in Grenada. Of 12,103 registered voters, 5,510 did not vote. That is more people than the entire electorate of the Town of St. George or of St. George North West. The register grew by 1,200 names since 2022, yet 426 fewer ballots were cast.

The arithmetic of a comeback starts there. To overturn the 2026 result, the NNP would need 1,397 voters to switch sides, or 2,793 extra supporters to turn out, which is just over half of everyone who stayed home. That is a four-year job, not a campaign. The airport workers, hotel staff, university employees and young families of the south are exactly the voters the NNP says it wants. It has built nothing permanent to find them.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE SOUTH

St. George South will not be won back by the next caretaker named eighteen months before an election. It can be won only by a party that starts now and treats the seat as a four-year campaign. The steps are not complicated. They have simply never been tried here.

Year one, 2027: choose a candidate who lives in the constituency, and commit publicly to keeping that person for at least two elections, win or lose. Open a permanent office on the Grand Anse corridor with paid staff, funded centrally by the party rather than left to the caretaker. Map all 33 polling divisions, from Springs to Calliste, and build a household list of the 5,510 who stayed home and the voters who have drifted away since 2018.

Year two, 2028: run a listening programme by sector, not just by village: hotel and restaurant workers, airport staff, SGU employees and students' landlords, small businesses and vendors on the beach strip. Publish what residents say their top problems are, in their words, and build a short local programme around three of them. Register new and young voters every month, not every election.

Year three, 2029: hold the sitting member to account in public with a quarterly constituency report card, measured against the government's own promises for the south. Recruit a captain for each of the 33 polling divisions and train volunteers to contact every household on the list at least three times a year. Start with the eight Blessed Sacrament divisions and Springs, where the NNP's vote held up best.

Year four, 2030: campaign on a record of presence. By then the NNP candidate should have attended more community events, solved more individual problems and been seen in more neighbourhoods than any challenger in the seat's history. Set honest targets: win back the 1,116 voters lost since 2022, then reach into the non-voters. Recovering the 2022 vote alone would cut the margin by more than a third. Winning the seat means persuading roughly 1,400 people to

switch, or finding nearly 2,800 new supporters.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

Mr. Williams has shown the method. He was local, he was visible, and he turned office into presence. In 2022 he won by bringing new voters to the polls. In 2026 he held them while the NNP's own supporters stayed home.

The NNP's failure here is not that it lost to him. It is that it never seriously tried to become the party of the south. Until it does, St. George South will remain what the last four elections have made it: a revolving door for the NNP, and a home for whoever the NDC sends there.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. GEORGE SOUTH

Measure	2018	2022	2026
NNP votes	3,536	2,961	1,845
NDC votes	2,678	4,029	4,637
NNP share of two-party vote	56.9%	42.4%	28.5%
NNP two-party share nationally		48.0%	37.7%
Winning margin	NNP +858	NDC +1,068	NDC +2,792
Registered voters		10,903	12,103
Turnout		64.4%	54.5% (lowest of 15)
Registered voters who did not vote		3,884	5,510
Polling divisions won by the NNP			0 of 33
Switchers the NNP needs to win		535	1,397

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates. 2026: DPM 87, GSDP 8. 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 33 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Pick a local candidate early, and keep them for two elections.
2. Fund the caretaker centrally: an office and staff are the minimum.
3. Do not parachute in: the 2022 candidate lost the south, then lost Carriacou.
4. Chase the 5,510 non-voters, not just the party faithful.
5. Organise by sector: hotels, airport, SGU and small business.
6. Recruit a captain for each of the 33 polling divisions.
7. Publish a quarterly report card on the sitting MP.
8. Do not mistake a minister's personal vote for a party base.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; read 7 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2013 and 2022 results; constituency profile); The New Today (2018 and 2022 results; 2022 candidate reports; NNP caretakers report, 2025); NOW Grenada (NNP caretakers, Apr and Sep 2025; acting PM appointments; 2026 results and candidate list); NNP (full slate, Feb 2026); Grenada Informer (25 Apr 2025); Government of Grenada (minister profile). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 10 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.